

Google Mobile

Accessing Google via your cell phone or PDA is the ultimate in having information at your fingertips while on the move. Liberated from the Desktop and laptop, Google's mobile services enable you to search the Web, search the mobile Web (Web sites specially designed for viewing on cell phones and PDAs), search images, view news, and even check your Gmail. Even if the screen is cramped and you need to become a finger acrobat with all those buttons, nothing beats the convenience of being able to access all this "anytime, anywhere." Well, almost!

15.1 Mobile Device Requirements

To use Google's mobile services, your mobile device should have a Web browser that supports XHTML (WAP 2.0), WML (1.2) or iMode (chtml). Normally, this is transparent to the user, and all you need to do is type in www.google.com to access the Google search home page. XHTML is the latest standard for mobile content, and supports both text and images. Most mobile devices bought in the last two years should support this format. iMode also supports text and images, and is a format primarily for the Japanese market. If you bought your device direct from Japan, you can rest assured of being able to access Google's content even if it only supports iMode. WML is an older format and only supports text. If you are having trouble accessing the Web, try www.google.com/xhtml, www.google.com/wml, or www.google.com/imode.

Depending on the Google service you wish to use, the mobile device should also be set to accept cookies. Additionally, the mobile network should allow cookies to be set as well and also secure SSL traffic. Both these features are the responsibility of the service provider. If you face any problems, check with your mobile provider if they allow cookies to be set and to secure SSL traffic.